

Altered State Publishing Designing Workflows for Alternative Publishing

Students research an exhibition catalog, write a counter-narrative, and design a faux page – published directly into the book. **We love pedagogy, but our systems treat this as damage.** How do we treat it as publishing?

WORKSHOP SESSION

10 + 30 + 10 MIN



The Provocation

What happens when an object asks to be read, handled, described, preserved, and circulated, but does not fit the systems built to manage those things? Zines, pamphlets, artist publications, and other small press objects often resist easy classification. They blur the line between publication and artifact, between record and intervention. What assumptions do our systems make about authorship, authority, format, value, and permanence?



Vídeos do Vimeo



Place this work

Join the web's most supportive community of creators and get high-quality tools for hosting, sharing, and streaming videos in gorgeous HD with no ads.

Mini Zine

Create a mini zine about a text that has been challenged, dismissed, debated, or overlooked. Your zine should take a position: defend it, critique it, reinterpret it, or argue why it belongs in a collection. (10 Mins)

Choose a text that is:

- banned or challenged
- controversial
- widely loved but you disagree with
- widely dismissed but you think matters
- not usually treated as “scholarly”
- personally meaningful and worth preserving

Mini-Zine Anatomy

Front Cover: Title

The original book's title and author.

Inside Spread 1: Consensus

What critics, scholars, or the public say about the text.

Inside Spread 2: Your Voice

Your personal critique, defense, or reinterpretation.

Inside Spread 3: Intervention

One specific thing you would add, change, or challenge in the book.

Back Cover: Your Mark

Your name, alias, or chosen identifier.

The Secret

Outliers

The Alchemist

The 4-Hour Workweek

The Baby-Sitters Club

Wuthering Heights

Animorphs

50 Shades of Grey

Colleen Hoover

Warrior Cats

Men are from Mars, Women are from Venus

Harry Potter

Sweet Valley High

The Catcher in the Rye

James Patterson

The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn

Perks of Being a Wallflower

Invisible Man

The Bible

House of Leaves

All Boys Aren't Blue

The Da Vinci Code

Guns, Germs and Steel

And Tango Makes Three

The Bluest Eye

Gender Queer

Infinite Jest

Tuesdays with Morrie

The 1619 Project

Dune

A People's History of the United States

The Second Sex

Giovanni's Room

Black Boy

Pedagogy of the Oppressed

The Giving Tree

Americanah

Fahrenheit 451

Lolita

How to be an Antiracist

Caste

Goodnight Moon

Stone Butch Blues

Stamped from the Beginning

Discipline and Punish

The Color Purple

Persepolis

Distinction

Sister Outsider

Captain Underpants

The Hate U Give

Ulysses

Gender Trouble

Mini Zine

What you just made is a physical intervention into a field of meaning.

By folding paper, selecting language, adding images, and shaping a small publication, you did more than express an opinion. You entered into relation with other texts in a visible, material way. Your zine does not sit outside scholarship. It interrupts it, extends it, and reframes it. It makes argument tangible.



The Breakout: Infrastructure Design

In this scenario, library interventions have been created by students, they have brought the items to you along with "Context Cards". Participants split into two working "Departments" – each handed a physical book with a student insert and a focused design prompt. We will be capturing what we make to add to the toolkit, see the release forms.

Group 1: The Editors

Policy & Ethics

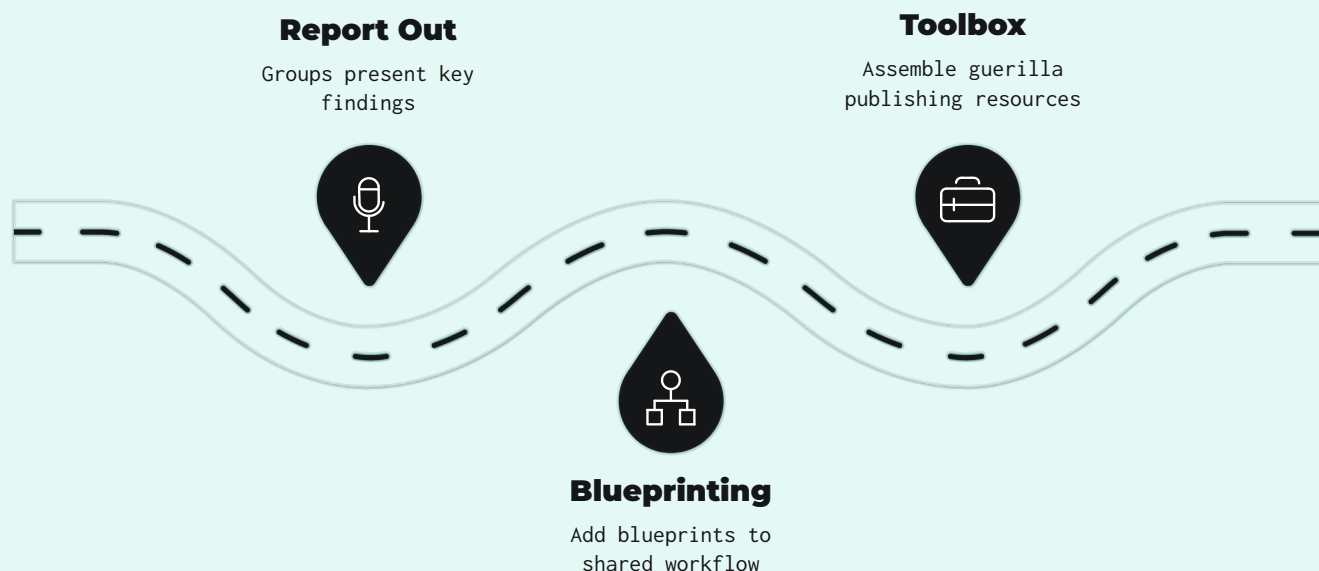
- Write the "Acceptance Criteria" – who approves what gets inserted?
- Design a peer review process for student-authored content
- Resolve copyright questions around the original text

Group 2: The Catalogers

Discovery & Metadata

- Spine sticker, MARC record note, or QR code to the IR?
- Make the intervention findable – without erasing the original
- Draft a metadata schema for student interventions

The Blueprinting: Building Live



Each group doesn't just share ideas – they add their blueprint directly to a projected, shared digital workflow. The toolbox is built in real time, capturing both outputs and recorded conversation. capture conversation.

Policy Drafts

Acceptance criteria and ethics frameworks (Group 1)

Metadata Schemas

Discovery solutions and cataloging workflows (Group 2)

Recorded Dialogue

Live conversation captured as part of the toolbox artifact

What was missing?

What aspects of this process were missing when comparing it to normal workflows? What questions were not answered that would have helped? What questions have opened up new ways of thinking for you? What departments don't have input?

Help us generate as many new questions as possible...

Your Guerilla Publishing Toolbox

Leave with a shared link to everything built today – policy drafts, workflow diagrams, and metadata schemas, ready to adapt for your institution.

Toolbox

Search

Editors

Artifacts

Catalogers

Artifacts

Blueprint

Artifacts

Dialogue

Workshop

Slides

Zines

Photos

Release Form

Github

Workshop Artifacts

These artifacts were produced live during the workshop. Two groups worked in parallel — one on policy and ethics, one on discovery and metadata — then combined their outputs into a shared workflow diagram. Nothing here is finished. Everything here is a starting point.

The Editors drafted acceptance criteria, a peer review process, and resolved copyright questions for student-inserted materials.

The Catalogers designed metadata schemas, physical indicators (spine stickers, QR codes), and MARC local notes for works that blur the line between publication and intervention.

Blueprint documents the shared workflow diagram built live during the report-out — tracing the path a student intervention takes from submission through review, cataloging, and onto the shelf.

Dialogue captures the questions the workshop generated that it didn't have time to answer — about preservation, accessibility, weeding, donor relations, and what a fully realized version of this program would require.

Editors →

Workshop Artifacts

Toolbox - CC BY-NC-SA 4.0



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